Why I Moved From Manhattan to Miami

Channel: Brandon Carter · Published: Nov 01, 2026 · Watch: https://www.youtube.com/shorts/B8VbEFBmd30 Source: full transcript

📋 Executive Summary

After 15 years on Manhattan's Upper West Side, Brandon Carter relocated to Miami for one reason only: eliminating state income tax. He chose Miami over Las Vegas for its New York-like energy.

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🗽 Leaving New York 0:00

- Lived in Manhattan for **15 years**, specifically on the Upper West Side
- Describes New York as "my favorite city in the world" and says he had a great time there
- The sole reason for leaving: New York state income tax
  - Calls it "more than I wanted to deal with"
  - Made a deliberate decision to identify states with no state income tax

🏙️ Choosing Between Miami and Las Vegas 0:22

- Narrowed his options to cities he actually liked that also happen to be in no-income-tax states
- Final two candidates were **Las Vegas** and **Miami**
- Las Vegas consideration:
  - His brother lives there and he has family in the area
  - Ultimately ruled it out — felt it might offer "too many distractions"
- Miami was chosen because:
  - The vibe felt closer to New York City
  - More aligned with what he was already accustomed to

💡 Takeaway for High Earners 0:22

- His direct recommendation: if you earn a good income and are not tied to a specific location, move to a state with no income tax
- Framed as a straightforward financial optimization with significant upside for high earners